

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Pentecost 11
Another Kind of Freedom ~ Healing Division
16 August 2026

LVF updated 3pm Friday

Preaching: LVF

Worship Leading: ML & Lauren Seely

STRIPS OF PAPER IN PROGRAM FOR PRAYERS

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Emma Whitten, *Guest Organist*

Chiming of the Hour

[ML & ... center chancel]

Welcome

ML

Words of Gathering

ML & ...

We are inseparable from generations past
and generations future.

The lives of the ones who came before us
are present all around us.

The needs of those to come call upon us this day.

What are we doing with all we have inherited -
the wonderful and the terrible?
What will we leave behind?

*May the Holy things, the righteous things,
the things that make us brave in spirit
and fierce in hope
be our source of wisdom and guidance
as we strive to live faithfully-
to the Sacred
to each other
to those past and yet to come
in these perilous and precious days
we have been given.*

May it be so.

May it be so for all of us!

[-enfleshed]

***Hymn of Gathering**

[Michael center chancel]

***Prayer of Awareness and Confession**

ML

Holy One of freedom and liberation and reconciliation -
you have given us the law, spoken through prophets,
and provided us with the Spirit to help guide us
in love and justice.

Still we struggle.

The complexities of life and challenges of being human
often win over. In our pain we harm one another,
we do not intervene when our neighbors are targeted,
and we become possessive of power and resources.

Forgive us, O God.

And then, Gracious One,
ground our lives in mutual care and connection,
as we share with you - a vision of the belovedness
of each one of us, which is always and forever -
the cornerstone of your collective reality.

*For this and so much more, we are grateful.
Amen and Amen!*

[adpt/enfleshed]

***Introit**

Let All the World in Every Corner Sing

Ralph Vaughan Williams

Dr. Fahad Siadat, *Conductor*; Dr. Emma Whitten, *Organ*

***The Lord's Prayer**

Let us join together in this Lord's Prayer, adapted by enfleshed...

*Weaver of Life, Ancient and Unfolding,
How Sacred is your Presence!
We lean on your guidance.
We seek your love.
We open to your transformation.
Provide us bread in body and spirit
to sustain us in faith and solidarity.*

*Companion us with grace
as we seek to live lives of forgiveness and compassion,
repair and accountability.
We remember those who have supported us
as we seek to support others
in all the mess and glory of this human journey.
Guard our minds and hearts from the temptations of domination
and turn our loyalty away from all systems of evil.
For the whole cosmos hums with your wisdom.
Everything that lives, returns to your care.
Our thanks and honor to you,
Gracious Web of Existence,
Our Source and Our Home.*

[enfleshed]

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Michael center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace**

Please be seated

[... to lectern]

Reading from the Wisdom of Our Tradition *from the Gospel of Luke*
Hear now this reading from the Gospel of Luke, chapter 9...

As the time approached when he was to be taken from this world, Jesus firmly resolved to proceed toward Jerusalem and sent messengers on ahead. They entered a Samaritan town to make preparations for him, but the Samaritans wouldn't welcome Jesus because his destination was Jerusalem. When the disciples James and John saw this, they said, "Rabbi, do you want us to call down fire from heaven and destroy them?" But Jesus turned and reprimanded them. Then they set off for another town.

This is the Gospel of Grace.
Thanks be to God!

[Emma short transition Michael to center chancel]

Prayers with the People

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

Silence

[After 2 minutes, Emma transition out of silence and play as people come forward to offer prayers and light candles]

Prayer of Our Hearts

[Emma transition Laude to positions]

Meditation Anthem	<i>That Which Can't be Explained</i>	Peter Eldridge/Arr. Katelyn Dietz
	Laude	

[Emma transition Laura to pulpit]

Sermon	<i>Healing Division</i>	LVF
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[Emma transition ... to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity

Gardens QR Code

Offertory Anthem	<i>Rondo</i>	John Carter
	Brandon Harris, <i>Soloist</i> , Dr. Emma Whitten, <i>Piano</i>	

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[... to lectern]

***Offering Prayer**

Please be seated

[Michael and Laura center chancel]

Life at First Church

LVF & ML

Words of Blessing

LVF

As we leave this sacred time and space,

Let us gather our courage in community, because...

We can do hard things

Brave things

Beautiful things

Risky and transformative things.

The Sacred travels with those who journey toward freedom.

For the sake of the collective life

For the sake of disrupting evil

For the sake of the human soul.

We are called and companied,
never really alone.

*May our hearts be encouraged both this day -
and in all the days to come.*

[-enfleshed]

Amen and Amen!

Choral Response

Amen

Kelly McCandless

So let it be. So it shall be. Let us love one another. Amen.

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Michael center chancel]

Postlude

Inside The Music